

Literature

General Lit.
Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

This course includes the following topic(s): Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6, General Lit.: Grades 5-6

About General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Read living books full of memorable characters, surprising plot twists, and heartwarming endings. Due to the rise of Children's Literature in the 19th century, students read period literature rather than historical fiction this year and will spend about a term and a half each with *Little Women* and *Hans Brinker*.

About Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Students read Roman, Norse, and Eastern mythology, Dickens' *A Christmas Carol*, and a selection of short stories and fairy tales written or collected in the 19th century.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Poetry lessons are an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Easily combined with Grade 4.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Suitable for hungry 4th graders. *A Christmas Carol* and some stories and tales shared with Grades 7-8.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	General Lit.: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 20 min	<i>Hans Brinker</i> or <i>The Silver Skates</i> <i>Little Women</i>
5-6	Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	<i>The Age of Fable</i> <i>South American Jungle Tales</i> <i>Russian Fairy Tales</i> <i>A Christmas Carol</i> <i>Short Stories & Folktales</i>

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 5-6				
Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6		General Lit.: Grades 5-6		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ Read the preface and introduction of *The Age of Fable* for background information about myths and the rationale for reading them.

☐ Print "Age of Fable Glossary" for easy access during lessons. Find the link in Quick Links below.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

☐ With engaging and straightforward narrative, *King of the Wind* (Term 1) eases students into the year and is a great book for them to read independently and use for written narrations.

☐ Due to the length of the books, students will not finish *Johnny Tremain* (Term 2) or *Treasure Island* (Term 3) in the scheduled lessons. Encourage students to finish these books on their own time over Exam week or on breaks. Both are riveting stories and are great options to encourage a lifelong habit of reading outside of school.

☐ *Treasure Island* (Term 3) contains a few instances of racist and/or outdated language, and wine and rum appear regularly throughout the book. Some notes are added in the lessons, but you will want to decide how to discuss these realities with your students.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ *The Age of Fable* (Term 1) is best as a read-aloud or assigned as a stretch book for independent reading after the first few lessons are done together. Vocabulary may be difficult to understand, but can be comprehended in context. Reference the glossary in Quick Links as needed. These stories reference imaginary creatures and ancient deities. It is a good idea to think ahead about how you might explain these characters if your students ask.

☐ *Black Ships Before Troy* (Term 2) and *Nearer My Freedom* (Term 3) are great books for written narrations and more independent reading. However, since Homer's famous epic is all about the famous siege of Troy and Equiano's book is a slave narrative, they have some hard and gory parts throughout, which teachers may wish to preview or read with more sensitive students.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grades 5-6

General Lit.: Grades 5-6



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates



Little Women

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6



The Age of Fable



South American Jungle Tales



Russian Fairy Tales



A Christmas Carol

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grades 5-6

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

∞ [Age of Fable Glossary](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Literature: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.

- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Literature: Grades 5-6

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Term 1

WEEK 1	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1	
WEEK 1	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 1 <i>Adventures of Aeneas and Dido</i> Materials: Age of Fable → INTRO Virgil wrote the Aeneid between 29 and 19 B.C. We will be reading stories and poetry from this epic work this term. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.31 p.207-213 "We have followed" - "to the Sibyl"	COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Caption Phineus and the Harpies or another scene.
WEEK 2	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2	
WEEK 2	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 2 <i>Elysium and the Sibyl</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.32 p.213-221 "As at the" - "in number less."	COMPOSITION - Act Out The meeting of Aeneas and Dido in the land of the dead
WEEK 3	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3	
WEEK 3	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 3 <i>Introduction to Infant Rome</i> Materials: Age of Fable → RECAP: WHAT DO YOU REMEMBER ABOUT HOW THE UNDERWORLD WAS DESCRIBED IN THE LAST CHAPTER? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.33 p.221-230 "Aeneas, having parted" - "along the main."	
WEEK 4	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4	
WEEK 4	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 4 <i>Pythagoras</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.34 p.230-248 "The teachings of" - "were no more." → VIEW Here is a bust of Pythagoras. ∞ Image Link: Pythagoras	COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Tell The death of Osiris or another scene.
WEEK 5	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5	
WEEK 5	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 5 <i>Origin of Mythology & The Minerva of the Parthenon</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.35 p.241-249 "Having reached the" - "fame have immortality." → VIEW Here is one artist's image of Jupiter and a Roman statue of Minerva. ∞ Image Link: Jupiter ∞ Image Link: Minerva	COMPOSITION - Expository Tell at least three theories on the origins of mythology.
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6	
WEEK 6	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 6 <i>Modern Monsters</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.36 p.250-256 "There is a" - "these sacred fires?"	

Literature: Grades 5-6

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Term 1		
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7	
WEEK 7	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 7 <i>Eastern Mythology & Siva</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.37 p.256-264 "Our knowledge of" - "Quiloo and Melind." ∞ Image Link: Brahma ∞ Image Link: Vishnu	
WEEK 8	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8	
WEEK 8	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 8 <i>Loki and His Progeny</i> Materials: Age of Fable → INTRO In the last several years, the popularity of Marvel comic movies has revived the popularity of mythological characters like Thor and Loki. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.38 p.264-269 "The stories" - "long into Niffleheim."	• COMPOSITION - Descriptive Describe Thor.
WEEK 9	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9	
WEEK 9	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 9 <i>Thor's Visit to Jotunheim</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.39 p.269-275 "Once upon a" - "a verdant plain." → VIEW Look at this runestone, which was carved during the Viking age. The three figures in the center are Odin (with the spear), Thor (with the hammer), and Freyr (with the sickle). ∞ Image Link: Runestone of Norse Mythology	• COMPOSITION - Written Retelling Thor's Visit to Jotunheim
WEEK 10	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10	
WEEK 10	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 10 <i>The Death of Baldur & Ragnarok</i> Materials: Age of Fable → INTRO It is amazing that these rune stones still can be seen today. Most were engraved during the Viking age, making them around 1,000 years old. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.40 p.276-282 "Baldur the Good" - "by the Northmen!"	
WEEK 11	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11	
WEEK 11	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 11 <i>The Druids</i> → INTRO It is hard to believe some festivals we read about still occur in Scotland today. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.41 p.282-288 "The Druids were" - "but witness mine!"	
WEEK 12	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12	
WEEK 12	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 12 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Age of Fable	

Literature: Grades 5-6

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Term 2		
WEEK 1	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 1	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 2	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14	
WEEK 2	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 14	
WEEK 3	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 3	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 4	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 4	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 5	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17	
WEEK 5	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 17	
WEEK 6	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18	
WEEK 6	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 18	
WEEK 7	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19	
WEEK 7	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 19	
WEEK 8	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20	
WEEK 8	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 20	
WEEK 9	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21	
WEEK 9	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 21	
WEEK 10	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22	
WEEK 10	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 22	
WEEK 11	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 11	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12	 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24	
WEEK 12	 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 24	

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Term 3		
WEEK 1	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 1	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 2	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 3	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 4	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 5	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 6	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 7	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 8	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 9	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 10	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 11	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36	
WEEK 12	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 36	

Literature: Grades 5-6

Examination

Term 1

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- In writing or picture, describe a scene from the adventures of Aeneas OR the story of Isis and Osiris.
- Describe Ragnarok in words or pictures.